

Sloptractions Synthesis

Transform dialectic outputs into a polished essay in the style of Venkatesh Rao's "sloptractions"
— AI-assisted writing at "meso" abstraction with a structural recipe at the end.

When to Use

- You've completed a dialectic and want to turn it into a shareable essay
- The dialectic produced genuine insight — a reframing, a hidden question, a synthesis
- You want the essay to be **pleasurable, not just summarizable**
- You want to expose the method (the recipe) so readers can apply similar moves

The Sloptractions Method

Based on Rao's corpus (LLMs as Index Funds, Prompting is Managing, Autoamputation Flow, etc.):

1. **Provocation/Hook** — Concrete phenomenon that illustrates something larger
2. **Reframing via analogy** — Map onto a well-understood system from another domain
3. **Conceptual currency** — Coin precise terms that do load-bearing work
4. **Structural unpacking** — Decompose into layers, phases, or tensions
5. **Implications/Stakes** — What follows if the reframing is correct?
6. **Recipe** — Expose the generative moves as imperative verbs

What makes this different: - **Meso-level density** — more detail than humans hold unassisted, less than AI handles autonomously - **Structural transparency** — the recipe says "here's how the sausage was made" - **Human brings the moves** — reframe, unpack, trace propagation, coin term - **AI executes at density** — fills implications, generates prose holding many threads

Process Overview

This is an **interactive workshop**, not an autonomous pipeline. Each phase ends with a checkpoint where the user validates or redirects.

Phase 1: Inventory	→ User confirms: "These are the key elements"
Phase 2: Analogy	→ User picks from candidate analogies
Phase 3: Concepts	→ User validates which terms do work
Phase 4: Outline	→ User approves arc before writing
Phase 5: Write	→ Draft produced
Phase 6: Validate	→ User reviews, requests revisions

IMPORTANT: Read each phase file only when you reach that phase. Do not read ahead. This keeps instructions fresh in context and prevents skipping checkpoints.

Starting the Process

1. Ask the user which dialectic they want to transform
2. Read phases/1-inventory.md
3. Execute Phase 1, ending at its checkpoint
4. Only after user confirmation, read phases/2-analogy.md

5. Continue phase by phase

The user can intervene at any checkpoint — redirecting, adding constraints, or returning to an earlier phase.

Phase Files

- `phases/1-inventory.md` — Survey dialectic outputs, identify key elements
 - `phases/2-analogy.md` — Find and propose analogical domains
 - `phases/3-concepts.md` — Coin and validate conceptual currency
 - `phases/4-outline.md` — Map material onto the sloptractions arc
 - `phases/5-write.md` — Draft the essay
 - `phases/6-validate.md` — Review and polish
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Recipe Variations

Style	When to Use
Numbered conceptual moves	Essay follows a clear build-up sequence
Process description	Work was more exploratory (“scan → reframe → structure → style”)
Co-authoring protocol	Want to expose the human-AI collaboration
Honest mess	Process was genuinely messy